Standard: SECURITY-POL00015-STN00034
Driver: Joseph Wallace
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Classification: Internal

Data Backup and Restore Standard

1. Overview

The Data Backup and Restore Standard outlines the minimum requirements for backing up and restoring both data required for the continuing operation of Adobe services and data stored on behalf of Adobe customers.

These requirements are in force regardless of the durability or resilience of the associated storage systems to internal failure. They are intended to protect against data loss due to software bugs, misconfigurations, and external threats.

2. Scope

All Adobe personnel must comply with this Standard to the extent that they are responsible for management of Data in Scope (as defined in Section 3.1). Members of Business Application and Product Teams, and Backup Administrators have additional responsibilities to maintain compliance with this Standard, as further detailed in Section 7.

This Standard applies to all environments that collect, store, process, transmit, or dispose of data. There may be requirements in this Standard that apply only to those environments that handle specific classifications of data, as described in the Data Classification and Handling Standard, for which Adobe has unique obligations (for example, cardholder data or electronic protected health information). Such additional requirements are described within Sections 3.5 and 3.6 of this Standard. Any environment containing such data must comply with all generally applicable requirements and any additional requirements specified for such data.

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3. Statement

3.1. Data in Scope

- Business Application and Product Teams must ensure that backups which meet the requirements of Section 3.2 are maintained for the following types of data:
  - 3.1..1 Persistent data critical to the operation of Adobe business processes, products, and services
  - 3.1..2 Persistent data stored by Adobe on behalf of a customer
- Business Application and Product Teams must note that the durability or internal resilience of a storage system does not exempt in-scope data from the requirements in Sections 3.2 and 3.3.

3.2. Backup Requirements

- Backup Administrators must ensure that backups are stored:
  - 3.2..1 In a different availability zone, failure domain, or Hosting Location from the source data.

3.2..2 With encryption of data at rest, implemented as required by the Data Classification and Handling Standard.

3.2..3 With protection from modification, enforced by the design and configuration of the backup storage systems.

- Backup Administrators must ensure that backup access control mechanisms:

  3.2.3 Prevent modification of backup data after backup completion.

  3.2.4 Prevent administrative access to backup processes, systems, and storage by Business Application and Product Teams.

- Backup Administrators must ensure that backups are:

  3.2.5 Created at least once every 24 hours.

  3.2.6 Retained for a minimum of 14 days.

  3.2.7 Capable of having their retention modified to comply with legal holds.

  3.2.8 Unless otherwise expressly permitted and approved in writing by the Data Governance Operating or Steering Committee, only used for the purpose of backing up and restoring data to protect against data loss due to software bugs, misconfigurations, external threats, or circumstances resulting in data center inaccessibility.

- Backup Administrators must ensure that backup systems provide on-demand reporting of:

  3.2.9 Backup configuration details

  3.2.10 Inventory of the source data protected.

  3.2.11 Backup tasks and their associated success or failure.

  3.2.12 The last restore operation for any protected data, the user who initiated it, and evidence of its successful completion.

3.3. Restore Requirements

- Backup Administrators must provide on-demand restore functionality for Business Application and Product Teams.
- Business Application and Product Teams must validate their backup configurations via a successful restore of representative source data at least once per calendar year.
- Business Application and Product Teams must ensure that restored data is compliant with data retention and deletion policies, such as those identified in Section 9.

3.4. Requirements for Periodic Review

- Business Application and Product Teams must:

  3.4.1 Confirm annually that all in-scope data complies with the requirements of this Standard.

  3.4.2 Maintain documentation of all non-compliant in-scope data and any associated mitigating controls.

- Backup Administrators must work with Business Application and Product Teams to prioritize and address non-compliant in-scope data identified during periodic review.

3.5. Requirements Specific to ePHI Environments

- Business Application and Product Teams whose source data includes electronically protected health information (ePHI) must maintain weekly, monthly, and annual backups in addition to the two weeks of daily backups required by Section 3.2.3.

3.6. Requirements Specific to FedRAMP Environments

- Business Application and Product Teams whose source data exists in FedRAMP environments must adhere to the following requirements, in addition to any outlined in the FedRAMP Environment Protection Standard :

  3.6.1 Maintain daily incremental and full weekly backups for all systems, file systems, databases, and other storage media. (FedRAMP CP-9a).

  3.6.2 System backups must include all operating system, application, and user data. (FedRAMP CP-9).

  3.6.3 Backups must be stored in a different geographic location than the source data. (FedRAMP CP-6).

4 Violations

Minor issues complying with this Standard are non-punitive and are part of Adobe's continual improvement. Minor non-compliance will be dealt with at the local team or service level.

Major violations that involve violation of laws, violation of written agreements, or willful disregard of the Standard may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment or contract.

5 Exceptions

Exceptions are subject to approval and are granted based on having both a legitimate business justification and having sufficient mitigating controls in place. Exceptions are only ever temporary and never permanent. To request an exception for consideration, please go to the Technology Policies and Standards site and complete the exception request form.

6 Definitions

Term	Definitions
ePHI	Electronic Protected Health Information.
FedRAMP	A United States federal government-wide compliance program which details their requirements for use of cloud products and services.
Hosting Location	Defined by the Adobe Hosting Standard
Persistent Data	Data stored by a software application which is expected to remain intact and available over time, separated from the lifecycle of an individual transaction, session, or operation. This excludes testing data and any temporary data generated by our software applications.
Source Data	The authoritative copy of any Data identified by Section 3.1. This is typically the original or initial copy.

7 Responsibilities

Group	Responsibilities
Business Application and Product Teams	• Identify all in-scope data associated with their application or product according to the requirements of Section 3.1 • Ensure that all in-scope data is backed up to meet the requirements of Section 3.2 • Ensure that restore testing is completed to meet the requirements of Section 3.3 • Provide annual confirmation of compliance with the requirements of Section 3.4
Backup Administrators	• Expand backup and restore service capabilities to support data stores identified in Section 3.1, given business investment and prioritization. • Maintain backup and restore services whose functionality, configuration and operation meets the requirements of Sections 3.2 and 3.3 • Work with Business Application and Product Teams to address data protection gaps to meet the requirement of Section 3.4.2

8 Governing Policy

This Standard is governed by the Business Continuity Policy. The Business Continuity Policy establishes Adobe's commitment to create and maintain a Business Continuity Plan and requisite standards for responding to unexpected interruptions in Critical Business Functions (CBFs). This policy supports Adobe's business continuity through directives towards the implementation and use of a fully supported Business Continuity Plan (BCP). The Business Continuity Policy also establishes the need for all CBFs within the scope of the policy to conduct Business Impact Analysis (BIA) and define a Disaster Recovery Plan.

9 References

The below documents are referenced in this Standard:

- Data Classification and Handling Standard : The Data Classification and Handling Standard establishes that all data collected, processed, transmitted, stored, or destroyed by or on behalf of Adobe must be classified and then protected in accordance with its designated classification.
- FedRAMP Environment Protection Standard : The FedRAMP Environment Protection Standard is a comprehensive governing document that provides requirements specific to environments in place for FedRAMP customers, also referred to as FedRAMP environments.
- Hosting Standard : The Hosting Standard governs the hosting providers, locations, and names which may be used to deliver Adobe Services. The Standard is maintained with inputs from across the business and with specific consideration for regulatory requirements, taxation, vendor service availability, and our existing product infrastructure investments.
- Personal Information Retention and Deletion Policy : The Personal Information Retention and Deletion Policy states that Adobe may only retain Personal Information for as long as there is a legitimate business or legal need to retain it for the purposes for which it was collected, as well as for compatible or related purposes (the "Retention Period")
- Consumer Personal Information Retention Standard : The Consumer Personal Information Retention Standard establishes Adobe's retention and deletion practices for consumer personal information
- Employee and Applicant Personal Information Retention and Deletion Standard : The Employee and Applicant Personal Information Retention and Deletion Standard describes Adobe's or an Adobe group company's (collectively "Adobe") legal requirements for retention, storage, and deletion of all data, files, records, agreements, contracts, correspondence (including emails) relating to Adobe Workers which are processed in Adobe's Human Resource Management IT Systems (collectively "HR Data").

10. Document Properties

Property	Description
Classification	Internal
Original Published Date	8/28/2004
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Coordinator	Policy Module Admin; Ensures that Approval Occurs	Harrison Martorana, Technology Compliance Product Owner, Tech GRC
Driver	Coordinates Document Drafting, Reviews and Updates	Joseph Wallace, Sr. Manager, Digital Asset Governance

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Approver	Approves Document and Exceptions; Ultimately Responsible for Execution	Maarten Van Horenbeeck, Chief Security Officer Nubiaa Shabaka, VP, Chief Cyber Legal & Privacy Officer Cynthia Stoddard, Senior Vice President and Chief Information Officer
Accountable	Ultimately Responsible	Maarten Van Horenbeeck, Chief Security Officer
Contributor	Provides Recommendations; Subject Matter Expert; Critical Reviewer	Click here for Contributor list
Informed	Receives Document Status Updates; Stakeholders	Click here for Informed list

11. Document History

Version	Approval Date	Changes	Approved By
1.0	08/28/2004	Initial Version	
2.0	10/01/2009	Changed retention periods to decrease costs and optimize backup data protection environment	
2.1	11/10/2009 05/26/2010	• Formatting and fonts • Posted in Information Security Wiki	
2.2	10/29/2014	• Changed backup frequency for Db servers from 'daily' to 'weekly. • Removed E-mail servers from scope. • Updated section 3.5 to present 'disk-based system' as back up media. • 4. Added second bullet point to section 3.9	Atul Gupta
3.0	June 2016	• Inclusion with PSP initiative format • Rounded content to be scalable and applicable to Digital Marketing as well. • Removed sections 3.6 to 3.9 based on redundancy and rewrote other sections to provide coverage • Made clarifications	Atul Gupta, Director of Hosting & Cloud Platform Services Dan Cutler, Director of TechOps Infrastructure Service
4.0	August 2017	• Revised 3.1.4 • Added 3.2.3, 3.1.5. 3.1.14 • Added FedRAMP specific content - section 3.5 • Moved previous 3.4.1 to section 3.1 and created sections 3.1.7 through 3.1.13	Atul Gupta, Director of Hosting & Cloud Platform Services Dan Cutler, Director of TechOps Infrastructure Service

Version	Approval Date	Changes	Approved By
5.0	August 2018	Major Changes • None Minor Changes • Spelling and grammar changes to clarify several requirements. • Rearranged several requirements to fit under more logical section headers. For example, 3.2.4 moved from section 3.1.	Atul Gupta, Director of Hosting & Cloud Platform Services Dan Cutler, Director of TechOps Infrastructure Service
6.0	August 2019	Major Changes • Added 3.5.1 regarding deletion of ePHI Minor Changes • Rearranged section 3.3 to make clear different retention requirements for different data contexts.	Matt McBride, Sr. Manager Infrastructure Services Atul Gupta, Director Infrastructure Operations
7.0	October 2020	Major Changes • No major changes in this version Minor Changes • Updated definition of 'Data'	Matt McBride, Director of Infrastructure Services Atul Gupta, Director Infrastructure Operations
8.0	November 2021	Major Changes • No major changes in this version Minor Changes • Responsibilities section - Grouped 'Hosting & Platform Services' and 'Digital Marketing Storage Services' to 'ATS CloudOps'	Matt McBride, Director of Infrastructure Services
9.0	December 2022	No Major Changes Minor Changes • Approver – Matt McBride replaced with Aaron Anderson	Aaron Anderson, Sr. Director, Infrastructure Engineering

10.0	June 2024	Major Changes
		• New, simplified language to clarify responsible parties and requirements; removed legalese from Sections 1, 3 and 6
		• Removed statements and references that are outside the scope of the standard from Sections 1, 3 and 6
		• Heavily revised Section 3
		  o Added new requirements associated with Ransomware protection.
		  o Removed language indicating that durable storage systems, versioning or snapshots alone are sufficient to satisfy the requirement for a backup.
		  o Added clarification that storage system durability does not exempt in-scope data from backup requirements.
		  o Organized backup requirements into topical subsections.
		  o Added clarification that Backup Administrators must ensure that backups are stored with encryption of data at rest, implemented as required by the Data Classification and Handling Standard.
			Mike Mellor, Vice President, Cyber Operations
			Nubiaa Shabaka, VP, Chief Cyber Legal & Privacy Officer
			Cynthia Stoddard, Senior Vice President and Chief Information Officer

Version	Approval Date	Changes	Approved By
		○ Clarified that backups may only be used for backup and restore purposes, absent a specific exception to be sought from and granted by the Data Governance Operating Committee. ○ Separated Backup reporting and restore requirements. ○ Clarified that Business Application and Product teams retain the responsibility for bringing restored data into compliance with data retention and deletion policies. ○ Eliminated requirements detailing basic operational competence (such as storing backups in reliable data storage systems, or responding to alerts from backup service components) ○ Removed restated and duplicated requirements from other data-related standards. ○ Section 3.5 – Updated ePHI requirements to detail backup retention requirements, removed source data lifecycle requirement that is beyond the scope of backup and restore activities. ○ Section 3.6 – Updated FedRAMP requirements for clarity, annotated each requirement with the associated FedRAMP control. • Section 6 - Removed definitions for terms no longer used in the standard. • Section 7 - Updated to reflect the changes in responsibility resulting from the updated requirements in Section 3. • Section 9 - Removed references for documents no longer referenced in the standard. • Section 9 - Added references to applicable Data Retention and Deletion Policies not present in previous revisions. Minor Changes • Section 1 – Replaced 'Adobe Systems' with 'Adobe' • Drivers – Ryan Price replaced by Joseph Wallace and Jon Meacham • Approvers – Aaron Anderson replaced by Maarten Van Horenbeeck, Nubiaa Shabaka, and Cynthia Stoddard	